

- D -

deceleration lane – expressway lane used to slow your vehicle without blocking vehicles behind you

defensive driving – protecting yourself and others from dangerous and unexpected driving situations by using a space management system

delayed green light – indicates one side of the intersection has a green light while the light for oncoming traffic remains red

denial – the withholding of a driver license or privilege because the person is ineligible for a license. A driver license may be issued when eligibility requirements are met.

depressant – a drug or alcohol that slows the response of the central nervous system

depth perception – the ability to judge distance between yourself and other objects

designated driver – the person who decides ahead of time not to drink alcoholic beverages and is appointed to drive others who do drink

distractions – when a driver is delayed in the recognition of information needed to accomplish the driving task safely because some event, activity, object, or person within or outside the vehicle compelled or tended to induce the driver's shifting attention away from the driving task

drag race – the operation of:

1. Two or more vehicles from a point side by side at accelerating speeds in a competitive attempt to outdistance each other; or
2. One or more vehicles over a common selected course, from the same place to the same place, for the purpose of comparing speeds or power of acceleration of the vehicle(s) in a specified distance of time

driving under the influence (DUI) – a Class C misdemeanor for which a minor can be charged in Texas if driving with any detectable amount of alcohol in the minor's system (An offense for which a driver can be charged in some states if the driver's blood-alcohol concentration is above 0.05.)

driving while intoxicated (DWI) – an offense for which a driver can be charged in all states if the driver's blood-alcohol concentration is above a certain level

- E -

entrance ramp – a ramp leading onto a highway

exit ramp – a ramp leading off a highway

- F -

field of vision – all the area a person can see while looking straight ahead.

field sobriety test – series of on-the-spot, road-side tests that help an officer detect impairment of a driver suspected of DUI or DWI.

financial responsibility law – a law requiring you to prove you can pay for collision damages you cause that result in death, injury, or property damage

flashing signal – traffic signal alerting drivers to dangerous conditions or tells them to stop

focus vision (foveal) – the part of the vision field which allows the driver to read signs and make distinctions between vehicles and objects often measured as visual acuity

following interval – the time recommended to follow another vehicle in the intended path of travel. Select an object near the road surface. When the vehicle ahead passes that object, start counting one thousand-one, one thousand-two, etc., until the front of your car reaches the same object. For speeds under 30 mph, the minimum time with good road conditions is 2 seconds. For speeds above 30 mph, maintain 4 seconds (more for adverse conditions) of following time. Developing a four-second following interval is the best practice for a beginning or less experienced driver

force of impact – the force with which one moving object hits another object; this varies according to speed, weight, and distance between impact and stop, and is based on forces of inertia and momentum

friction – the force creating heat which helps the tire maintain traction on the road, unless too much heat is generated which may cause traction loss due to melting of tire rubber on the road

- G -

gap – time or distance interval between vehicles on road

glare recovery time – the time your eyes need to regain clear vision after being affected by bright lights

glare resistance – the ability to continue seeing when looking at bright lights

graduated driver license program – requires young drivers to progress through a series of licensing stages with various restrictions such as accompanying drivers, times permitted to drive, and allowable passengers

guide sign – a sign providing directions, distances, services, points of interest, or other information